Indian Army's 4th Rajput Regiment captured these positions on 17 May 1965 only to have them returned by the political leadership after a composite ceasefire was announced in June 1965. Undeterred and thankful for the return of these two positions, Ayub Khan launched Operation Gibraltar two months later, on 5 August 1965. This involved mixing so-called *Mujahideen* with regular Pakistan Army troops and infiltrating through seven thrust lines in Gurez, Kupwara, Uri, Poonch, Mendhar, Naushera and Akhnoor. By 12 August 1965, 1,200 infiltrators had been captured. India's western army Commander, Lt. Gen. Harbaksh Singh, retaliated and captured four significant heights on the Muzaffarabad-Kel Road and also captured the Haji Pir Pass. These very positions were captured in 1948 and returned to Pakistan after the 1949 ceasefire! Operation Gibraltar ended with a whimper.

The backup, face-saving plan to follow Operation Gibraltar was Operation Grand Slam. This was an artillery-led support operation in Chhamb, which commenced on 1 September 1965. The possibility of Pakistan capturing Akhnoor as a consequence of Operation Grand Slam was countered by Lt. Gen. Harbaksh Singh by brilliantly opening up two new fronts in Lahore and Sialkot in the plains of Punjab. On 16 September 1965, China served India with a dramatic ultimatum asking India to withdraw from 56 alleged incursions into Tibet within three days or 'face the consequences'. These incursions were, in some cases, crude shelters put up by the Indian Army for its observation posts to provide protection from the vagaries of weather. Because of the ambiguity of the watershed, in some places, they were in what the Chinese perceived to be their territory.

These could have been easily resolved by talks and did not merit an ultimatum. The ultimatum, however, provoked British Prime Minister Harold Wilson to promise to India the support of both the UK and the US, if China intervened. The threat of global war loomed. On 19 September 1965, Ayub Khan paid a visit to Beijing to confer with Premier Chou En-lai; this was the first manifestation of the Sino-Pak strategic and military calculus envisioned by Lt. Gen. Cawthorn. The Chinese extended the ultimatum by another three days, until 22 September 1965. By this time, they knew that